

Use of the Life + Health Study analytic dataset is governed by a Data Use Agreement (DUA) with Harvard and by the Life + Health data-access review process. This summary is provided for informational purposes only and does not replace the legally binding DUA.

Eligibility and review process

Access to the Life + Health analytic dataset is not automatic. Requests are considered through a two-stage review:

1. **Scientific Review Committee** – assesses scientific rigor and alignment with the health-equity and anti-racism priorities of the original study; and
2. **Community Oversight Committee** – requires consensus approval by leadership from all three participating community health centers (Fenway Health, Mattapan Community Health Center, Harvard Street Neighborhood Health Center) and the Director of the Center for Community Health Education, Research and Service (CCHERS), to ensure that proposed work aligns with the priorities and values of the communities that provided the Data.

Only requests that receive full approval and execute a DUA with Harvard will receive access to the Data.

Permitted uses

- If approved, the Data Recipient will receive **one standard de-identified analytic dataset** for approximately 699 participants, including all variables described in the public Life + Health analytic data dictionary. No custom datasets or analysis services are provided.
- The dataset may be used **only for the single research project and Purpose described in the approved application and in Exhibit B of the DUA.**
- Any other use of the dataset—including new research questions, new projects, or teaching/training uses—requires Harvard’s prior written consent and, under current program policy, a new application, full review, and, if approved, a new DUA.

Prohibited activities

Data Recipients and their research teams may **not**:

- redistribute, share, sell, license, or otherwise transfer the Life + Health dataset, or any dataset containing individual-level Life + Health records, to any third party (including collaborators at other institutions) without Harvard’s prior written consent;
- engage in selling, licensing, or otherwise providing access to the dataset in ways that violate applicable U.S. restrictions on bulk sensitive personal data (including restrictions on transfers to “countries of concern” or “covered persons,” as defined in 28 C.F.R. part 202), as further detailed in the DUA;
- attempt to identify or re-identify any individual participant, clinic, or community represented in the Data, whether by using the Life + Health dataset alone or in combination with other information;
- attempt to contact any Life + Health participant; or
- use the Data for diagnosis or treatment of human subjects.

Security and data handling

- The dataset contains sensitive health and social information and must be handled as confidential research data.
- The dataset will be transferred using a secure, encrypted mechanism approved by Harvard. Data Recipients may not further transfer the dataset to other systems or locations without Harvard's prior written consent, except as permitted in the DUA.
- Data Recipients must store and process the dataset only in a **secure, institutionally managed computing environment** that provides protections at least equivalent to Harvard's Level 3 data security standard, including appropriate access controls, user authentication, and encryption.
- The dataset may not be stored on unencrypted portable media (e.g. unencrypted USB drives) or in personal cloud storage services (e.g. personal Dropbox or Google Drive accounts).
- Access to the dataset must be limited to the Named Investigator in the DUA and Recipient Researchers under the Named Investigator's supervision.
- Any actual or suspected security incident, breach, loss, theft, or unauthorized access to the dataset must be reported to Harvard (typically within 24 hours), as specified in the DUA.
- At the end of the DUA, all copies of the dataset must be securely deleted or destroyed, and Data Recipients may be required to certify destruction to Harvard in writing.

Publications and acknowledgment

- Publications and presentations based on the Life + Health dataset must acknowledge the study using the following or substantially similar language:
"This research used data from the Life + Health Study, supported by NIH grant R01MD012793 and by the American Cancer Society Clinical Research Professor Award to Krieger. We thank the Life + Health Study participants and the community health centers (Fenway Health, Mattapan Community Health Center, and Harvard Street Neighborhood Health Center) that facilitated this research."
- Prior to publication, Data Recipients must provide Harvard with a thirty (30) day period to review manuscripts solely to identify any confidential information or Data that should not be disclosed, as specified in the DUA.
- Data Recipients must provide Harvard with at least one copy of the final version of each publication generated under the DUA.

Duration and end of use

Access to the dataset is time-limited as specified in the DUA. At the end of the approved term, or upon earlier termination, Data Recipients must destroy or return the dataset as directed by Harvard, except that a single archival copy may be retained only as required by applicable law, regulation, or institutional records retention policies and solely for research integrity/verification purposes.

How to apply for access

The current application form is available at:

https://harvard.az1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_0dhd6tjArmB9fKK

Review meetings are typically held **quarterly**; applications must be submitted at least two weeks in advance of the next scheduled meeting. Unless otherwise specified on the Krieger Research Group website (<https://hsph.harvard.edu/research/krieger-group/data-sharing-resources/>), the Scientific Review Committee meets on the **first Wednesday of May, August, November, and February**. Applicants are generally notified within about one week of the review meeting whether their application will proceed to community review, and the final decision may take up to six weeks after the review meeting.